of forest and wildlife on the one hand and environmental issues, including climate change, on the other. The ministry is divided into three broad sets of divisions: establishment divisions, environmental divisions, and forest and wildlife divisions.

The environment part of the MOEF&CC needs to be entrusted with clear goals with respect to the five key determinants of environmental pollution in India, as explained in the previous section. It should be held accountable for making progress and achieving those goals. Forest management is also more akin to land management. The Government of India is not the best agency to manage forests, except setting the policy of protecting and growing forest area, as part of the larger environment policy. The management of forest land, forests and wildlife needs to be handed over fully to the states. The MOEF&CC should be made a pure play environment ministry to focus on environmental issues and to help India achieve its environmental goals.

Revamped Environment Ministry Will Need to Reinvent Itself

MOEF&CC should identify major sources of pollution and carbon emissions and take requisite measures to eliminate the root causes. India has taken such initiatives. In Delhi, emissions of CO_2, particulate pollution and nitrogen oxides, besides other pollutants, were majorly contributed by buses using diesel. The replacement of diesel engines with engines based on compressed natural gas (CNG) in buses reduced the pollution and carbon emission load significantly in the national capital.

The environmental regulatory system in the country needs to move from dictate-based regulation to a participation-based technology upgrade system. In 2015, MOEF&CC passed orders fixing emission standards for nitrogen oxides (NOx) and sulphur oxides (SOx) for all power plants in the country. For example, for power plants established between 2003 and 2016, NOx emissions were to be brought down to 300 mg/Nm3. Several other